Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative

June 2026

FROM EARTH, FOR EARTH



Every year, on 5th June, the global community unites for World Environment Day.

For 2026, the official theme is “Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.”

It’s a call to rethink how we live, work and care for the Earth.

Traditional village craft has always been inherently circular. When a piece of craft is made from natural fibres, it comes from the earth and returns to the earth seamlessly, leaving behind nutrients instead of waste. In this way, excess is minimized and materials are kept in use as long as possible.

With this in mind, a quiet revolution has been taking place in rural India.


industree
SVETA

GreenKraft, a women-owned, producer-led social enterprise and brand, incubated by the Industree Foundation in 2012, provides green livelihoods to over 4,000 rural women. It enables marginalised women in Karnataka, Maharashtra, Odisha and Tamil Nadu to unite in self-help groups and gain access to markets that would otherwise remain inaccessible to them.


Green Living
Green Values
Green Impact
Green Choices
Green by Design

These women-led collectives specialise in creating high-quality, hand-woven, eco-friendly products with agricultural waste like banana bark and forest products like bamboo and sal leaves. They adhere to stringent production standards, sustainable practices and learn production techniques to minimize carbon footprint.



Banana Bark, which is a by-product typically discarded after the fruit is harvested, is strong, flexible and fully biodegradable. This is transformed into handcrafted home décor, baskets, storage bins, planters and fashion products.



Bamboo rejuvenates the very soil it grows in, absorbs four times more carbon dioxide than other trees and releases 35% more oxygen than standard trees. Bamboo is used to make clothes, furniture, boards, brushes, festive decorations, lamps, tea-light holders and many other items.







Sal and Siali Leaves are collected by the tribal communities from the forest floor with zero tree felling. The leaves are stitched together with tiny bamboo splits and made into 100% biodegradable, compostable tableware and disposable plates, directly replacing single-use plastics.


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Imagine these women walking into a community centre close to their home, working on traditional crafts passed down generations. These hubs are places of community building, where artisans learn, collaborate and grow together. These women don’t have to choose between their families and survival.



Through training and shared traditions, they are transforming forest debris and agricultural waste into beautiful, fully biodegradable art. They are also transforming their lives into one of financial independence and empowerment. They gain confidence, recognition, and are able to provide for their family and children.



By eliminating middlemen and providing direct market access through a digital platform, GreenKraft is significantly boosting the economy of the rural women. They see their work travel through a fully traceable supply chain from their village to the shelves of global giants like IKEA and H&M.







It’s time to reconsider where the things in our homes come from, who made them, what are they made of and how are they disposed. It’s time to swap mass-produced plastic or synthetic items for handcrafted, natural-fibre alternatives that carry a positive ecological footprint.

Credits

Flourish Planet

GreenKraft

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